

SΔφ-61 — God and Gui

Non-Transactional Divinity, Transactional Transcendent Actors, and the Cost Terrain of Sacred Authority

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God is not invoked. Gui is invoked. What is invoked can be audited.

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Abstract

This working paper introduces the $S\Delta\phi$ distinction between God and Gui. In this framework, God is not defined by love, justice, personality, purpose, command, covenant, punishment, reward, or ritual relation. God is defined only as a non-transactional omnipotent condition: a condition that cannot be entered into human exchange, negotiation, command, punishment, compensation, or institutional justification.

By contrast, Gui is introduced as a technical term for a transactional transcendent actor: a sacred or supra-human authority that enters human cost-attribution paths through command, negotiation, offering, reward, punishment, protection, prohibition, covenant, ritual exchange, or social obedience. Gui is not translated as deity, ghost, phantom, spirit, or demon, because each of those translations distorts the operational distinction. The distinction between God and Gui is not a hierarchy of divinity. It is a distinction of operation.

$S\Delta\phi$ -61 does not prove or disprove God. It does not rank religions, deny religious experience, or score sacredness itself. Rather, it separates the unmeasured remainder of God from the measurable cost terrain created when the name of God is invoked inside human institutions, moral commands, political authority, ritual exchange, social punishment, or obedience structures.

Its central question is therefore not "Does God exist?" but: when a transcendent claim enters human transaction, does it still function as God, or has it become Gui-operation?

Keywords

$S\Delta\phi$; Sofience- $\Delta\phi$ Formalism; God; Gui; sacred authority; sacred marker; non-transactional divinity; transactional transcendent actor; cost attribution; UMR; sacred-marker remainder; theology; folk religion; command; obedience; ritual exchange; final adjudicator; God-Gui separation.

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1. Core Declaration

SΔφ-61 begins with a strict separation.

God does not negotiate.

God does not bargain.

God does not command in order to produce human obedience.

God does not require offerings, punishments, contracts, institutional representation, or social enforcement in order to remain God.

When a transcendent actor enters a human path of transaction - command, negotiation, covenant, offering, punishment, protection, reward, curse, taboo, legal authority, ritual obligation, or political justification - SΔφ classifies that actor not as God, but as Gui.

This is not a statement of contempt. Gui is not an insult. It is an operational classification.

The core declaration is:

God is the non-transactional omnipotent condition.

Gui is the transactional transcendent actor.

God is not invoked.

Gui is invoked.

What is invoked can be audited.

2. The Problem: When God Becomes a Human Cost Device

Human communities frequently use the name of God as a final adjudicator. A command is justified because God commands it. A hierarchy is stabilized because God ordains it. A sacrifice is demanded because God requires it. A punishment is legitimized because God wills it. A dissenting person is silenced because God has already judged.

In ordinary religious language, these statements may remain internal to a given theology. SΔφ does not attempt to invalidate those internal meanings. It asks a different question:

When the name of God enters a human cost-attribution path, what does that invocation do?

Does it lower the cost of obedience?

Does it raise the cost of dissent?

Does it make exit more expensive?

Does it make correction nearly impossible?

Does it transform human authority into sacred authority?

Does it externalize suffering onto those who are told that obedience, endurance, silence, or sacrifice is demanded by God?

The SΔφ concern is not the inner truth of religious faith. The concern is the operational use of divine invocation in human systems. In this sense, the phrase "God commands" is not treated first as theology. It is treated as a path-forming event.

The paper therefore separates God from the human use of God's name. God remains unmeasured. The invocation of God inside human cost terrain becomes auditable.

3. Minimal SΔφ Definition of God

SΔφ defines God minimally and severely.

God is not first defined as loving.

God is not first defined as just.

God is not first defined as personal.

God is not first defined as creator, judge, savior, ruler, or moral source.

God is defined only by omniscience and omnipotence in the strictest sense.

This omnipotence is not limited by human intuitions of logical consistency. If humans formulate a paradox, such as the familiar "stone that cannot be lifted" paradox, SΔφ does not conclude that God is limited. It concludes that human language has reached a boundary. What appears contradictory to human cognition does not define the limit of God. It defines the limit of human operational interpretation.

This definition deliberately removes divine personality, divine goodness, divine justice, divine love, and divine purpose from the minimum condition of God. Those may be traits, narratives, revelations, theological commitments, or devotional forms. They are not the SΔφ minimum.

The reason is structural. Once love, justice, or purpose is made a condition of God, contradictions multiply inside human moral language.

If God is defined as love, then the question arises: why does an omniscient and omnipotent God allow preventable suffering?

If God is defined as justice, then the question arises: why is evil not decisively and universally corrected?

If God is defined by command, then God becomes a participant in human obedience paths.

If God is defined by covenant, God becomes a participant in human transaction.

If God is defined by punishment and reward, God becomes a participant in human cost distribution.

SΔφ therefore strips the definition down to the non-transactional omnipotent condition. This is not a warmer definition of God. It is a colder one. It is colder because it refuses to let human morality, human consolation, human authority, or human institutional need define God.

4. Why Love, Justice, and Purpose Are Not Conditions of God

The exclusion of love, justice, and purpose from the minimal definition of God is likely to be the most uncomfortable part of SΔφ-61 for many theologians.

SΔφ does not deny that a tradition may worship a loving God, a just God, a merciful God, a wrathful God, a covenantal God, a creator God, or a personal God. A tradition may describe God in those terms. SΔφ simply refuses to make those terms the minimum condition for God.

The reason is that each moral attribute, once placed at the foundation, creates a human interpretive route through which God becomes usable in human disputes.

A loving God can be invoked to demand endurance.

A just God can be invoked to demand punishment.

A merciful God can be invoked to demand forgiveness from victims.

A wrathful God can be invoked to justify violence.

A covenantal God can be invoked to bind communities to inherited obligations.

A purposeful God can be invoked to interpret suffering as meaningful.

SΔφ does not say these invocations are always false. It says they are operationally dangerous when they become final adjudicators in human cost terrain.

Therefore, love, justice, mercy, wrath, covenant, and purpose are not denied. They are displaced from the minimal condition of God into the domain of theological characterization. Once they are used to create commands, obligations, punishments, taboos, social boundaries, or institutional authority, they enter the domain of Gui-operation.

5. Definition of Gui

Gui is a technical term in SΔφ.

Gui means a transactional transcendent actor that enters human cost-attribution paths.

A Gui may command.

A Gui may punish.

A Gui may reward.

A Gui may demand offerings.

A Gui may protect a place, lineage, institution, or community.

A Gui may be appeased, angered, invoked, negotiated with, represented, obeyed, or feared.

A Gui may be called a god within a religious tradition. SΔφ does not dispute that internal naming. It classifies the operation. If the transcendent actor participates in transaction, it functions as Gui in SΔφ.

Gui is not necessarily false.

Gui is not necessarily evil.

Gui is not necessarily primitive.

Gui is not a lesser being in a hierarchy of divinity.

Gui is a name for a specific operation: the entry of transcendent authority into human exchange, command, punishment, protection, ritual obligation, or social obedience.

The distinction between God and Gui is therefore not a distinction between higher and lower beings. It is a distinction between non-transactional omnipotence and transactional sacred authority.

6. Why Gui Is Not Translated as Deity, Ghost, Phantom, Spirit, or Demon

SΔφ-61 keeps the term Gui untranslated.

Gui is not translated as deity.

In ordinary usage, deity remains inside the semantic field of godhood, divine being, sacred status, or object of worship. If Gui were translated as deity, readers might interpret it as a lesser deity, local deity, folk deity, minor divinity, or alternative god. That would blur the God-Gui distinction. SΔφ does not define Gui by divine rank. It defines Gui by transactionality.

Gui is not translated as ghost.

Ghost is too narrow. It suggests the dead, haunting, apparition, or post-mortem presence. Gui may include ghost-like forms in some traditions, but $S\Delta\phi$ Gui is broader than the dead.

Gui is not translated as phantom.

Phantom suggests illusion, unreality, or insubstantial appearance. $S\Delta\phi$ does not define Gui as unreal. A Gui-operation can produce very real costs, institutions, fears, rituals, prohibitions, and obedience structures.

Gui is not translated as spirit.

Spirit is too broad. It may mean soul, mood, breath, divine presence, animating principle, non-material being, or cultural atmosphere. This semantic field is too diffuse for the operational distinction $S\Delta\phi$ needs.

Gui is not translated as demon.

Demon introduces moral condemnation. $S\Delta\phi$ does not define Gui as evil. A Gui may protect, comfort, organize, punish, bless, threaten, discipline, or sustain a community. Evil is not the criterion. Transactionality is the criterion.

Therefore, Gui remains Gui.

Gui is a technical term for a transactional transcendent actor that enters human cost-attribution paths through command, negotiation, offering, reward, punishment, protection, prohibition, covenant, taboo, ritual exchange, or social obedience.

7. The God-Gui Separation

The God-Gui separation is the central operation of $S\Delta\phi$ -61.

God is preserved as UMR: unmeasured remainder. $S\Delta\phi$ does not score God, disprove God, prove God, rank God, or define the interior truth of God.

Gui is analyzed as cost terrain. When a sacred actor or transcendent claim enters human transaction, the resulting command, obedience, fear, offering, punishment, prohibition, protection, or institutional authority can be analyzed.

This produces a strict split:

God remains beyond human transaction.

Gui enters human transaction.

God cannot be used as a final adjudicator inside human institutions.

Gui can be invoked inside human institutions, and therefore Gui-operation can be audited.

This separation prevents two opposite errors.

First, it prevents reductionism. $S\Delta\phi$ does not reduce God to a sociological function, psychological projection, economic instrument, or political device.

Second, it prevents sacred immunity. $S\Delta\phi$ does not allow a sacred claim to become immune from cost analysis merely because it invokes God.

The result is uncomfortable but precise:

God is not measured.

The name of God, when used inside human transaction, is measured by its cost terrain.

Operational summary table:

Category	God	Gui
Minimum definition	Non-transactional omnipotent condition	Transactional transcendent actor
Human relation	Cannot be entered into exchange, command, or negotiation	Can be invoked, appeased, obeyed, feared, bargained with, or represented
SΔφ treatment	Preserved as UMR; not scored or reduced	Analyzed as cost terrain
Risk	Misused as final adjudicator by human interpreters	Creates obedience, exit, punishment, and sacred-authority costs
Core question	Is this beyond human transaction?	What cost path does this invocation create?

8. The Transaction Test

SΔφ-61 introduces the Transaction Test.

When a transcendent actor is invoked, ask:

Does it command?

Does it demand obedience?

Does it require offerings?

Does it punish disobedience?

Does it reward compliance?

Does it negotiate with humans?

Does it bind a covenant or contract?

Does it protect a group in exchange for loyalty?

Does it create taboos whose violation produces social or metaphysical cost?

Does it authorize human institutions, rulers, clergy, castes, families, nations, or communities?

Does it raise the cost of dissent, exit, criticism, or reinterpretation?

If the answer is yes, then SΔφ does not immediately classify the actor as God. It classifies the operation as Gui-operation.

This does not mean the tradition is false. It means that the transcendent claim has entered human cost terrain.

Once it enters human cost terrain, the question changes:

Who pays the cost of the command?

Who receives the benefit of obedience?

Who can interpret the will of the Gui?

Who can object?

Who can leave?

Who is punished?

Who is protected?

Who gains authority by representing the sacred actor?

Who is silenced by the claim that the sacred actor has already decided?

The Transaction Test is not a theological refutation. It is an operational routing test.

9. Sacred Markers and Gui-Operation

Gui-operation often appears through sacred markers.

A sacred marker is a sign, phrase, ritual, object, office, text, name, symbol, law, taboo, or narrative that raises the cost of criticism, exit, correction, or substitution.

The phrase "God commands" can function as a sacred marker.

The phrase "this is God's will" can function as a sacred marker.

A ritual obligation can function as a sacred marker.

A priestly office can function as a sacred marker.

A taboo can function as a sacred marker.

A sacred text can function as a sacred marker when invoked to close dispute.

SΔφ does not score the sacredness itself. It measures the surrounding cost terrain.

What happens when the marker is invoked?

Does criticism become more expensive?

Does exit become shameful, dangerous, or impossible?

Does suffering become interpreted as obedience?

Does institutional authority become harder to challenge?

Does a human interpreter gain power by representing the sacred?

Does the victim lose a path of re-entry because the cost is explained as divine necessity?

If yes, then the sacred marker is not merely symbolic. It is a cost-routing device.

Gui-operation is the moment where sacred authority becomes path-forming inside human systems.

10. UMR and God: Non-Reduction Without Immunity

UMR - unmeasured remainder - is essential to SΔφ-61.

God is UMR.

The interior truth of God is not scored.

The sacred experience of a believer is not scored.

The mystery of faith is not scored.

The metaphysical status of the divine is not scored.

But UMR does not mean final immunity.

To preserve something as unmeasured does not mean allowing it to become the final adjudicator of all measured paths.

This is the difficult point.

SΔφ can say:

We do not measure God.

We do not deny God.

We do not reduce God to social function.

But when the name of God is used to command humans, redistribute cost, silence dissent, justify punishment, demand sacrifice, or stabilize authority, that human path is measurable.

Thus UMR has two functions.

It prevents the reduction of God into a numerical object.

It prevents the invocation of God from becoming an unchallengeable final authority inside human cost terrain.

UMR is not surrender to sacred authority. It is non-reduction without immunity.

11. Theology Under the God-Gui Separation

Many theological traditions will resist the $S\Delta\phi$ distinction.

For them, God is precisely the one who commands, reveals, judges, loves, forgives, punishes, saves, and enters covenant. A God who does not speak, command, judge, or relate may seem too abstract, too cold, or not religiously meaningful.

$S\Delta\phi$ recognizes this objection.

A tradition may define God differently inside its own theology. $S\Delta\phi$ does not control internal theological language.

But $S\Delta\phi$ applies an operational test. When a theological claim enters human cost terrain, $S\Delta\phi$ does not allow the claim to escape audit merely by saying "God."

Therefore, in $S\Delta\phi$:

A tradition may call a being God.

$S\Delta\phi$ may classify the operation as Gui.

This is not a contradiction. It is a difference of level.

Theology names from within devotion, doctrine, revelation, and tradition.

$S\Delta\phi$ classifies from the standpoint of cost attribution, transaction, command, and re-entry.

The strongest question $S\Delta\phi$ can ask a theologian is therefore:

Do you preserve God beyond human transaction, or do you drag your God into Gui-operation?

This question is not meant as a casual insult. It is a structural challenge. If God is truly beyond human transaction, then God cannot be used as a human authority token. If God is used as a human authority token, then the operation has entered Gui-terrain.

12. Folk Religion and Transactional Sacred Actors

$S\Delta\phi$ -61 may be easier to apply to folk religion, shamanic systems, local deities, ancestral spirits, village gods, mountain gods, household gods, protective spirits, and ritual exchange systems.

Many such systems do not require an omnipotent God. They involve beings who protect, warn, punish, bless, demand offerings, accept rituals, respond to taboos, inhabit places, attach to lineages, or enter negotiation through specialists.

SΔφ does not dismiss these systems as false or inferior. It says that their operational structure is Gui-like.

This can be useful for religious studies.

Instead of asking whether the local deity is truly God, SΔφ asks:

What paths does this Gui create?

What obligations does it stabilize?

What community boundaries does it protect?

What fears does it intensify?

What rituals lower uncertainty?

What costs are paid to maintain the relationship?

Who gains interpretive authority over the Gui?

Who can challenge the ritual system?

Who suffers if the ritual is not performed?

This approach does not reduce folk religion to superstition. It treats folk religion as a structured sacred cost terrain in which humans, places, rituals, memory, fear, protection, authority, and obligation interact.

In this sense, Gui is not a demotion of folk gods. It is a precise name for their transactional operation.

13. Political and Institutional Use of God-Claims

The most dangerous form of Gui-operation occurs when the name of God is used to authorize human institutions.

A ruler may claim divine mandate.

A clergy may claim exclusive interpretation.

A family structure may claim sacred order.

A nation may claim holy destiny.

A legal system may claim divine origin.

A war may claim sacred sanction.

A victim may be told to endure because God wills it.

A dissenter may be told to remain silent because God has already decided.

In SΔφ, these are not first theological statements. They are cost-routing operations.

They alter the cost of dissent, exit, correction, refusal, reinterpretation, and institutional change.

They may transform human disagreement into rebellion against sacred order.

They may transform institutional critique into blasphemy.

They may transform suffering into obedience.

They may transform authority into divine representation.

This is why the God-Gui separation matters. It prevents the name of God from becoming a human cost shield. If God is truly God, God does not need human authority to defend the divine. If human authority uses God to defend itself, SΔφ classifies that operation as Gui-terrain and audits its costs.

14. Misreadings and Limits

SΔφ-61 must be protected from several misreadings.

First, this document does not prove or disprove God.

It classifies the operation of transcendent claims when they enter human cost paths.

Second, Gui does not mean evil spirit, demon, false god, primitive god, or irrational superstition.

Gui means transactional transcendent actor.

Third, this document does not mock religious believers.

Faith itself is preserved as UMR. The cost terrain created by the invocation of faith is analyzed.

Fourth, this document does not claim that all religious authority is harmful.

A Gui-operation may protect, stabilize, comfort, organize, discipline, preserve memory, or reduce uncertainty. The question is not whether it is always bad. The question is what cost terrain it creates.

Fifth, this document does not replace theology, anthropology, sociology, religious studies, or history.

It provides an SΔφ routing distinction: non-transactional God versus transactional Gui.

Sixth, SΔφ itself must not become a new final adjudicator.

If SΔφ is used to mock, erase, or automatically delegitimize religious life, then SΔφ itself has become a cost-externalizing sacred marker. The analysis must remain open to UMR, MIC, and RVP.

15. Relation to the SΔφ Series

SΔφ-61 extends several prior SΔφ commitments.

From SΔφ-56, it inherits the distinction between sacredness itself and the cost terrain surrounding sacred markers. The sacred itself is not scored; the effects of sacred invocation can be audited.

From SΔφ-57, it inherits the suspicion toward surface ownership claims. Just as "my thought" is not automatically accepted as pure origin, "God's command" is not automatically accepted as final authority. The trace, cost, and re-entry path must be examined.

From the Operational Kernel, it inherits the low-cost activation structure: SΔφ analysis should not be applied to every religious statement by default. It should be activated when a transcendent claim becomes a cost-attribution path, especially through command, punishment, obedience, institutional authority, forced endurance, exit cost, or blocked correction.

SΔφ-61 therefore functions as a specialized sacred-authority module.

It does not analyze God.

It analyzes the human-world operation produced by the invocation of God.

16. Closing Declaration

The closing declaration of SΔφ-61 is simple:

God is not called down to settle human accounts.

When the transcendent enters account, exchange, command, punishment, protection, or obedience, it has entered Gui-operation.

God remains unmeasured.

Gui is invoked.

What is invoked can be audited.

Therefore, to any theology that uses the name of God to close human dispute, impose cost, demand obedience, silence dissent, or shield authority, SΔφ may ask:

Do you preserve God beyond human transaction,
or do you drag your God into Gui?

Korean closing formula:

신은 호출되지 않는다.

귀는 호출된다.

호출되는 것은 감사된다.

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